

Table 6.6 Volume Statistics

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Volume trend	67% down	68% down
Rising volume trend performance	−17%	−22%
Falling volume trend performance	−17%	−22%
Heavy breakout volume performance	−17%	−23%
Light breakout volume performance	−17%	−20%

Table 6.7 How Often Stops Hit

Description	Bull Market	Bear Market
Pattern top	2%	0%
Middle	16%	11%
Pattern bottom	70%	68%

Table 6.7 shows a table new to this edition: how often price hits a stop.

I split the pattern into three pieces: top, middle, and bottom. The top is the higher of the two peaks (B in [Figure 6.3](#)). The bottom of the pattern is the low at the valley between the two peaks (point C). The middle is, well, midway between the top and bottom.

In bull markets, price reached the top of the pattern just 2% of the time on the way to the ultimate low (after the breakout). Although bear markets show 0%, I actually found two samples where price reached the top.

If you wish to place a stop, then price will rise up to the middle of the pattern 16% of the time in bull markets, or recover (perhaps during a pullback) to the bottom of the pattern 70% of the time. Bear markets show similar performance.

In [Table 6.8](#) I mapped the breakout date into one of three decades, which the table shows, split into performance in the top portion of the table and failures in the bottom portion. Because bear markets only happened in the 2000s, they are not included in the statistics.

Performance over time. The 1990s showed the best performance from big Ms, but not so's you'd notice unless you traded a lot of them.